

# How to Win Over Today's DTC Buyer with WINEing (Sonoma County Vintners SCION session, September 4, 2025)

Sonoma County Vintners SCION educational seminar series. Recorded webinar, about 38 minutes. Published to YouTube as "How to Win Over Today's DTC Buyer with WineIng - Sonoma County Vintners SCION session 09 04 2025".

Speakers: Moshé Weizman, co-founder and CEO, WINEing (wineing.net), presenting; hosted by Tracy of Sonoma County Vintners. One audience question from Cindy Nelson.

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Capture note: transcript capture made for Team Sonoma Fyre on 2026-08-06 from the video's auto-generated captions, supplied by Rodolfo. The captions are automatic speech recognition, so proper nouns are unreliable: the captions render the company as "whining" (it is WINEing), "Ehlers's estate" (Ehlers Estate, Napa), "grand crew in Hillsburg" (Grand Cru, Healdsburg), and "commerce 7" (Commerce7). Timestamp markers were removed; the wording is otherwise verbatim, including filler and false starts. Slides shown on screen are not captured.

Caution for citation: this is a vendor presentation. Every performance figure below (conversion rate, turnover uplift, case-study revenue, winery count) is company-reported and unaudited. Treat as claim, not measurement, in the same way as the Giesen entry in sources.md. The speaker also asserts that "the wine market is still growing" and that people are not drinking less wine, which is contradicted by every measured source in this folder.

## Transcript

Good morning everyone. I am Tracy with Sonoma County Venters and happy to have you here. Today we are hosting our um fabulous new affiliate member whining. Um I have Moshche with us today and he's going to walk you through this fabulous um platform of collective buying. So, I'm just going to hand it over to Moshe. We will take um questions at the end and um I just look forward to hearing more about this great platform that you have created. Thank you, Tracy. Hello everybody. Good morning. Um it's a pleasure to be here, pleasure to take part um in the Sonoma V County Venters um organization. We're a proud member and uh thank you for giving me the the stage. Um, I'd be happy to take questions once I'm uh once I'm finished if that's okay by everyone.

Um, but but I will start by saying that should any of what I'm about to say be of interest um I will spend the next uh two and a half weeks um on the west coast. I will be in Oregon but then spending um 10 days in California. So I'll be happy to also meet if possible uh and follow up with any of you. um in person. Uh I want to also thank the fact that you're here and not harvesting uh which is appreciated. Uh and uh yeah, let's go right ahead. Um a bit about what we're going to um to talk about. I'm going to give a brief intro about myself, uh the company, um what's the issue with wine club registrations, why are they declining, and how is it related to the younger generation? And uh how does the concept that we are uh banking on which is collaborative buying um solves those uh challenges challenges mainly around the issue of the declining number of case buyers.

The fact that people don't want to buy um a case uh but also don't necessarily want to commit to a club uh long term. These are dilemmas that our platform we believe um is solving. Uh we're going to go through at least one actual um use case that we've done recently in Napa by the way though we have Sonoma County wineries customers already just to give you an example of which circumstances in which circumstances do we excel um and also how easy it is and how simple it is to uh implement um uh collaborative buy uh without necessarily making it a big deal or complicated in terms of the infrastructures and the products that you uh already use. So um a bit about us. So we are two co-founders. Uh my co-founder is Dutch based in the Netherlands. Um I'm myself have been in enterprise software for more than 20 years. Uh but I'm also WCT level 3 graduate and I'm certified sumeier.

Uh so the what we created here um is the the result of a lot of consumer related challenges that I found um as a heavy um wine drink. Um so just a bit about the challenges of DTC um specifically in the US maybe even more specific in in California um but also general challenges. So I don't know how many of you know but the documented statistical uh uh of people that are not case buyers uh is that somewhere between 80 to 85% of

people do not buy by the case. The actual number is somewhere between 1 to five. Um which says a lot about your ability to sell in cases. It doesn't mean it's not possible, but it does mean that you're missing a lot on those that are not case buyers. Um, also something linked to the actual purchase, uh, we see, and I I I hope you don't see it, but I assume you see it, um, a decline, um, in club uh, signups.

Um, and also most club signups are of an age uh that is relatively uh high over 55, even closer to 60. Um, there's the challenge of the younger generation. They're not really uh into, as I mentioned, long-term subscriptions, not into buying the same thing 12 times. um and not into the financial engagement of being um club member. Um they just live differently and they think differently and they buy differently and they when they buy they buy it in digital contexts that are a bit uh distant from the the current way that wine is being bought um today. Um a very very recent um Silicon Valley Bank report literally from a few days ago also estimated that most wine club uh memberships um are originating by a visit to the tasting room.

I'm sure it's not new to you, but what we will try and prove and what we see that we are proving is that you can also get members uh and more member qualified people from other means that are not necessarily your tasting room and we will talk about it um a bit about the younger generation um dilemmas. We've mentioned it briefly but this is a very documented uh issue. Everybody's fighting uh fighting it. Um we see that wine is trailing RTDs and spirits um in whatever is digital sales. Um we see canned wine starting to grow. Um and we see the classic younger generation quotes of not wanting a case, not the long-term commitment. Um and they want something that is uh good live and immediate. um or in other words insta sharable moments. Hence kind of a social media gamified um experience, social discovery, uh something that is flexible.

Um all of all of that uh is still lives with the very interesting fact that the wine market is still growing. Um I mean it's it's the the growth is there. So it's not that people are drinking less wine, it's just they just buy it uh differently and they buy different types u of wines as well. So the bottom line of all of this is that if you keep trying to sell wine the same way you've been trying to do historically, you're either you already hit a wall or you're soon to hit a wall. change needs to happen and we believe that represents a big opportunity for new digital players and we hope to be um such a such a player. Um what what do we do? Uh so we invented this term this concept of the whining triangle. Uh we take circumstances they could be digital or physical where u a winery um has u an audience again digital or physical.

That audience has the high intent to buy and a good deal is offered to that audience. Those circumstances are circumstances that wineries already have today. those gatherings of people in the context of wine. That happens in the tasting room, that happens in any winery visit, it happens at festivals, it happens at offsite dinners or tastings at uh tasting rooms um all over. Um and it also happens when wineries go out and do tastings at members houses or any other circumstances that has people brought together to drink wine. Our concept and I will explain it in a second takes advantage of that gathering that high intent and the good deals that are offered in that uh circumstance and simply simply converts better. Why? Because it takes your quantity sales, your quantity offers, excuse me, and instead of limiting to one person, they're making them uh collaborable. And I will explain why.

uh these are just the use cases that I mentioned before. So we're talking tasting rooms, workshops, uh on the on the physical aspect, but there are also digital contexts of gatherings. So sending out a mail to your mailing list or to your club members is a digital gatherings. uh but there are other gatherings which could be leveraged by wineries either sales into corporates or dinner events or also B2B uh sales to restaurants and retailers. Those circumstances are gatherings and you need to leverage them better than the way u you're uh you're doing it today. Um, I'm gonna uh uh move from this screen to my uh to a demo because I want to um give you a u a quick demo of the of the platform. Hold on while I browse. All right. So um whining is not a uh is it's not the group on of wine. It's not a marketplace. It's not a website where a lot of wineries uh offer their goods.

No offer whining is a tool. It's a it's a digital platform then that when a winery or any other seller wants to use us once they go through a very easy onboarding process which basically involves uploading the products that they want to sell they get from us a dedicated URL which is basically a readytouse e-commerce platform that is solely

theirs and solely for that specific sale. Think of it. I mean, people have called us kind of the Airbnb of wine. It's it's an e-commerce ready platform for you to use wherever you want to and whenever you want to, for how long you want to. And once the sale which you decide its timelines is completed, that URL will not be valid anymore. So, if for example, and you will see after my demo, you would like to try a collaborative sale to three groups that are about to visit your winery a certain day.

You will get three different URLs and each will be a URL that is dedicated to each sale. Um something important we since I mentioned we're not a marketplace we're not an open website we're a functionality we are not responsible for generating the traffic. Okay, we are responsible and we do claim to convert better on traffic that you already have at those gatherings that I mentioned. Again, either at the winery, on your mailing list, club members, or any other type of event, physical or digital, you have the audience. Try to sell to it collaboratively. What you're doing right now is trying to sell to it individually. And that's what what we're changing.

So back to my example, when a winery wants to use us, it goes through a very easy onboarding process and then it gets from us a URL, that URL could be shared over newsletters, over SMS, or over a QR code at the tasting room if it's a physical event. People click the link or the QR code and they reach the example that you're looking at right now. Okay. So, there's a popup which could be fully um customized and once uh people get in, they basically see the sale. So, something to mention here, the bottles here, the prices are merely examples. Don't pay attention to it. It's just to basically let you know how the platform works. So, let's take the example of this Svenon on the on the left. So what you see here is something that the winery decided to offer. It is an offer for a case meaning 12 bottles of a svenl but the there's a discount associated to that case.

So if 12 bottles are purchased of that bottle the discount applies and the discount is here at the top. Usually there are two things that are an incentive for collaborative buy. It could be a discount, but it could also be a limited edition of something like an old vintage, library wines, magnums, etc. So that rule of 12 bottles minimum for discount was applied to all of the bottles here. There are six. So if I'm a user, what I do is I just basically mix and match what I want to pledge for. So I can pledge for one Svenon BL and then for two of this white blend and maybe this Italian cap. Once I'm done with my pledging, um, I go to the checkout page and there are details here to be put, personal details, shipping details, and payment details. But there's no charging at this point.

The charging happens only at the end of the sale should the products that the person pledged for reached their targets. And if target isn't reached, there's no charge. I let's assume I filled in all of my details. Once I go back, the other people with me, they will see my pledges on these as the bottles here will get colored. It's like a progress bar. And that's precisely what in what takes the collaborative aspect and makes people understand make people understand that they're not alone. and there's something brewing here and that something is growing and there's something to do and collaborate to to reach a certain uh goal. What we're doing here is basically creating a virtual community of users that have a common goal, a limited amount of time and a good deal offered to them. And from that point on, the psychology of e-commerce takes over.

And when these circumstances are physical, and the example, the live example that we did was physical, people start talking to each other, playing with each other, engaging with each other, um asking each other to collaborate, oh, we're missing one wine on our deal. Do you want to join this deal, etc., etc. So, it's a really fun and gamified experience. Moreover, a very simple, maybe even stupid feature that we have that has um proved to be very effective is the share button. So, think of a scenario where you're at such a tasting and there's a wine there that you know your father, your best friend, your fiancé, whoever would love, but they're not there. you can very easily share it with him and encourage him to participate as well for everybody's um interests and then to some extent the buyer becomes a promoter. That's it. That's the concept and it's it's it's not rocket science.

It's merely taking advantage of circumstances that we believe you as a winery you already have. But because your e-commerce uh part the the end of the funnel the part where the person needs to decide whether he buys what he buys and how much that process is individual and we're turning it into a collaborative uh process. It's it seems like everything about wine is collaborative except the buying part and that's what we're changing. I'm going to stop this share and go back to my um presentation and I will be happy to take uh questions afterwards

for the for the demo.

Um so just to summarize our value the value is that we uh we see at least in the 80 plus or 90 plus sales that we've already made we see that in the same circumstances where an individual e-commerce concept has been applied we see that we generate more uh more money we generate higher turnover how through this gamified engaging kind of sales process als also that is very similar to what the younger generation is doing in other parts of their lives like social media and uh and games. Second, how do we generate more turnover is that this is basically a pop-up tool. You can use it whenever you want, wherever you want. Um I know wineries have this uh sometimes these ambassador programs where they have ambassadors going around spreading the the brand awareness to their wine. Give them a tool to also leverage those circumstances to sell.

Use your winery dinners outside of the winery to sell, not just to hope someone will register to your club. you you're making it difficult on yourself by limiting it these off winery events only for marketing and club uh member registrations sell first second the value comes with data collection okay um all of the data that is accumulated during a sale whether it reached its goal or not is yours the wineries because we are not a website or a marketplace, we have absolutely no interest in keeping the data. All of the data that we collect of anyone who has pledged will be yours. Name, mobile number, email, where they live, that's a qualified lead, which sometimes in the normal way of people entering a tasting room, sometimes it's lost. And that's value that is being lost. Um and last the dig the digital enablement. You you literally don't need anything to use whining.

You you just well you contact us. You go through a very easy onboarding and you can use it uh wherever and whenever you want. A bit about what we've done so far. So we have we've already a revenue generating platform. Um, our model right now is that at least the first time that you will try to sell with whining would be for free. After the first time, most probably a commissionbased uh uh business model, mid to long term, maybe even a subscription based. So, wineries won't be limited in the amounts of time that they use um whining. Um what we've seen in our completed sales is that we have somewhere between 25 to 40% of a higher turnover than in the exact same use cases but without a collaborative uh uh tool. Um and second a very high uh conversion rate.

So today, uh, if you know anything about e-commerce and you have an e-commerce site, um, if you have somewhere between 2 to 3% of a conversion rate, you're probably doing something good. So our average conversion rate is around 15%. That's very, very high. Why? Because of how we do it. We make we get people to collaborate when they're offered a good deal. It's very simple. Um we already have uh 15 wineries. Most of them actually are in Sonoma. I'm happy to share some of the names. I think I have a slide on it as well that have already used us at least once if not uh more in many different use cases as I mentioned. I will give an example of at least one of them. Um something that's very interesting and coming up um is that we're taking part in come over October if you know it.

So it's a uh it's a it's a movement that is supporting u u smart and fun uh collaborative consumption of wine and we've partnered with them to offer whining uh to the wineries or retailers that are taking part in the movement to not only offer people to drink together but also to buy together.

And we actually have already I think 10 wineries specifically from Sonoma that are taking part um in this uh come over October u sale uh sales sorry a bit about the traction around us you can look it up yourself but we've been I I hope in a positive way making some noise uh podcasts uh researches uh mining report uh LinkedIn etc the the industry I don't have to tell you is looking for new players new ways of doing things and we do something um different this is a very good example of a use case we had literally uh a month and a half ago I think or a month ago in Napa uh we were approached by Ellers's estate uh specifically by their uh marketing and DTC persons um they told us that on average between two to four times a month they go out of the winery to do either dinners or tastings of of any kind.

Um, and those tastings, as as I mentioned before, are tastings that are usually used for either just marketing u giving the club member in the example that we did u a good treat because the tasting is done at a club

member's home. And third, but most importantly, try to generate more club members. And they literally had very very low success in their the past year or two u of doing that of doing that. And the marketing lady wanted to see if those uh events could be leveraged uh for sales if they're not being successfully leveraged for any other uh purpose. And we did such events uh three nights in a row. Uh so there was a person from the winery at three uh club members houses who invited somewhere between 15 to 20 people in each event and those are those who were mostly non-members. The house was of a member.

He was the one hosting it but the attendees were were not and there were wines offered uh at these events via whining. uh there was a discount associated with a minimum of uh I think 24 bottles and those were three consecutive successes. Okay. In one and a half hours of event they sold on average um about \$4,000 worth of wine um just over 70 75 bottles each evening. And not only were they were they able to give the the people a great experience and a good price, but they weren't trying to push a subscription to them. However, the data of those people who are already buyers is is now with the winery's hand in the winery's hand to follow up with and possibly propose a membership. So that was something that's was quite um successful.

Well, some of the names that are already using us both um in in in California uh but also uh in uh Europe uh and also uh joint uh tasting rooms uh working with the grand crew in in Hillsburg, which is a great place to gather wineries for their tastings. and whining is is a classic tool for such events. Um what what we've learned so far um is that obviously there's a DTC challenge especially uh around with the younger generation and the younger audience how to address them how to reach them how to make them buy more.

uh we see that I mean no question the gamification elements they generate engagement which automatically generates um sales um and also the the the power of offrem uh collaborations like those dinners and like those other types of out of the tasting room events uh which are now could be le which now could be leveraged for sales There are a lot of gatherings out there that could be leveraged for sales that are not being uh attended to uh enough right now. Three disclaimers I mentioned already. One, we do not generate new traffic for the winery, at least not directly, because remember we are enabling the people to share the deals with people that are not at the tasting and exposed to the deal. But we do not generate new traffic. We are converting better on traffic that the winery already have has.

Right now the tool is being used as a standalone uh tool meaning we do not have not now but it will change um in November come November when we will have an integration both with commerce 7 and Shopify. That means that the platform is kind of a standalone tool that the winery each winery can use very very easily. Uh and last which is a question we all all always get and possibly you already have it uh in your mind. It's the shipping and the fulfillment. We do not touch the product. We are just a software. We apply the shipping rules of the winery to our sale. So that could be pickup if you're at the winery. It could be a fixed a flat fee. It could be a free shipping if uh either you reach a certain amount in your cart or a certain amount of bottles. Or you could apply a certain cost per amount of bottles per three, per six, per 12, whatever.

We apply the shipping routes to each sale that you want to to generate. Um conclusion uh the concept is new it's modern it's very consumer oriented to to really change and boost uh your DTOC u strategy uh all of our use cases or at least 90% of them if they're built properly drive more revenue more engagement and more data collection and customer acquisition. Um the platform is very very easy to use and and do a sale with. There's really nothing to lose at least in trying it once. Um I I mentioned it. I'm in Sonoma and in Napa over the next um two weeks starting from the 11th of September. I'm going to be in Oregon first. But very happy to to come by and meet any interested winery, give a demo and explore a use case. Uh there's no need to do big sales at once. Uh very easy, simple use cases could be set up uh either at the tasting room or even a a social flash sale to your social media.

No need to offer a lot of products. Three to six is fine. Um and the the tool also you know enables you to uh to compensate or to uh encourage people to to share the deals. Uh you can give uh incentives for those who share. You could already give existing ambassadors the ability to use the platform. It's it's very easy, very simple, and nothing nothing really to to lose. Um, that's it. You can jump on our our website to to see a bit

more about what we do perhaps uh more about the press that we've gotten and documentation and obviously contact me uh directly through this uh email. Uh, I'm going to be sharing with Tracy these uh this deck. So, you could also have a look at it again or spread it. Um, and and I think uh we can open up to questions if there are any. Um, I saw some chats which I didn't read Tracy, but I'll let you take the lead. Sure. Thank you for that presentation.

I think the collaborative buying is an a really forwardthinking idea like you mentioned Moshe that we all drink together so why not buy together and having that sharing option makes it fun and it's um innovative. It's similar to a reverse auction right you get excited about what you're buying and it's a collective on who else wants this product except you get a discount at the end rather than paying more. So, I think it's a really great um new tool that wineries can implement and um I hope that somebody has questions that's on here. Um the question from Cindy Nelson um have you had luxury high-end brands particular, how do higher price bottles um fare in this context with a discounted bottle? Mhm. Well, I uh I wouldn't uh I don't know how to qualify Ellers. Uh I don't think it's uh uh it's a luxury brand.

Uh but it's not your I mean it's I think the average was 5060 maybe even \$70 bottle. So that doesn't qualify luxury but it's not um low otherwise. Um I know that the discount issue is um also a branding issue that people sometimes are um afraid of. Um but as I said there's this instinctive link to collaborative sale and discount. The incentive does not need to be a discount. So you could offer a discount which is great and you could also offer a discount not for a case. You could offer it for three cases, but you would not limit it to one person buying those three cases. So, you could do that. However, with luxury brands who are a bit uh not even luxury brand, even other brands who are a bit concerned with what the concept of constantly discounting does to them, they don't need to use a discount.

They could um uh they could use a limited edition of something uh which is also an incentive to drive people to collaborate uh and create this FOMO kind of effect. Uh we've had that with older vintages while that are not available on the market. Uh so the use case I gave was for non-members but for members who I know already have discounts um that could work. I mean offering uh certain bottles which may not be offered on a day-to-day basis even not to members um in totally different use cases which I don't believe are relevant to to wineries but in Europe we've had importers um pre use whining to pre-ell pallets of wines before they even bought it from the winery. So we've had Dutch importers importing pallets of of wines from Piamont or from Tuscanany but not actually ma buying the wine themselves before they reach their target.

So it was really great for everybody because the people really felt they're part of their own import uh which has which had a some discounted incentive but we've all also had you know between countries even in Europe some countries have allocations to premium wines because wineries tend to keep the premium and the rare wines to themselves. So they had allocations. So there was a FOMO there which wasn't necessarily linked to a discount and people collaborated and it went uh it went great. We we do have a winery in Sonoma actually. I I won't mention the name uh which used in standard use cases but are now using us to sell to retailers and restaurants in the big Californian cities. Why?

they they didn't do it before because first of all their brand wasn't known and second of all they didn't want to drive to San Francisco or Los Angeles or Sacramento whatever for one case however they were very interested even if it means selling only one case or two when they enable a few restaurants to collaborate and buy four or six bottles each but together they reach the one or two case minimum, it was still worth the winery's time to make the drive because what was important to them is not necessarily the quantity, but the fact that they're now on three new places uh wine lists. So, there are a lot of use cases. I think the major hurdle is to try the collaborative model. It's just so new and different to wineries that that's the main hurdle. But when people try it, nine times out of 10, and you know, we're here to help qualify the use cases. Nine times out of 10, it it just works.

That all all makes sense. Is there any other questions from anybody? There were sound issues. Oh, which we fixed. Okay. Yeah. Well, like Moshe said, he'll be in the area. Um, please co contact him or myself if you have any further questions or want to set up an appointment with him. Um, I'm looking forward to meeting him in a

couple weeks and um if there's no questions, I guess we can conclude. Thank you so much for your time today and um again your innovative platform. I think it's great. My pleasure. Thank you, Tracy. and I'll send over uh the deck uh so you can share it uh by all means. Thank you very much. Thank you. Thank you. Bye guys. Bye everybody.